

I'm an African international student from Tunisia, currently seeking asylum in the United States. I hold an F1 visa. I'm very low-income. To be able to remain enrolled at Columbia, Armand Link, an undergraduate Computer Science major in GS, generously co-signed a private educational loan for me so that I could keep my student visa and avoid deportation. He recognized the suffering I have experienced, as a fellow gay man, the persecution I endured in Tunisia where homosexuality is illegal. He co-signed my loan so that I could continue my education and avoid deportation. There is a Columbia article in which he shares his experience:

<https://www.gs.columbia.edu/news/their-own-words-river-divided-my-childhood-and-shaped-my-future>

In addition, to afford Columbia thus far, I have relied on fundraising. The 116th Initiative, an organization dedicated to helping Columbia students navigate financial hardship, organized a campaign on my behalf. Through the generosity of many members of the Columbia community, we raised approximately \$17,000. This was extremely challenging, and it required the support of many Columbia students to help me keep my visa and avoid deportation. The campaign was featured on their official Instagram:

https://www.instagram.com/p/C_Q37ESJ7r0/?hl=en&img_index=1 and

https://www.instagram.com/p/C_ITepJpi7X/?hl=en&img_index=1

I'm not sure how I'm going to be able to cover my upcoming tuition charges. Given all of the above, I also want to share that I am now having to move out of my Columbia apartment because I simply cannot afford the rent anymore. My financial situation is the direct reason I am leaving, and it has become impossible for me to meet both my

housing costs and my educational and immigration-related obligations. For this reason, I am not in a position to pay the lease-breaking fee, even though I understand it is part of the standard policy. I would be deeply grateful if, in light of my circumstances, you would consider waiving this fee, as it would significantly ease the burden I am facing and help me remain safely housed while I work to stay enrolled and continue my education.

Thank you in advance for your kind assistance and understanding.